

USEFUL WEBSITES

OPEN SOURCE HARDWARE

Open source hardware are such hardware where designs like mechanical drawings, schematics, bills of material, PCB layout data and others are released under free/libre terms. Here are a few websites that will introduce you to a few commonly-available open source hardware and communities

Compiled by **NIRAJ SAHAY**



poppy-project.org

This is an open source platform for the creation, use and sharing of interactive 3D-printed robots. Poppy is an interdisciplinary community of beginners and experts, scientists, educators, developers and artists, who all share the common thought that robots are powerful tools to learn and be creative. The community develops robotic creations that are easy to build and can be customised, deployed and shared.

www.poppy-project.org/en



netduino.com

Netduino is an electronics platform that software and electrical engineers can use to prototype new electronics products. It is used extensively in education and for personal projects. This open source hardware uses C# language and offers a rich feature set using Microsoft IDE, which debugs via USB. The website has a forum section that has more than 25,000 members to discuss the board and issues.

www.netduino.com



oshwa.org

Open Source Hardware Association aims to be the voice of the open hardware community, ensuring that technological knowledge is accessible to everyone and encouraging collaborative development of technology that serves education, environmental sustainability and human welfare. The website educates individuals and the general public about open source hardware. It also encourages collaborative learning, knowledge exchange and social cohesion through details of conferences and other events focused on open source hardware.

www.oshwa.org/about



beagleboard.org

BeagleBoard is a low-power, low-cost, fan-less single-board computer. *BeagleBoard.org* is an all-volunteer activity started by a group of passionate individuals, including several Texas Instruments employees interested in creating powerful, open and embedded devices. The website has a discussion board along with links that provide information regarding where you can buy the board. It also has references to around 200 different projects related to the board. BeagleBoard was designed with open source development in mind.

www.beagleboard.org



arduino.cc

Arduino is an open source physical computing platform based on a simple microcontroller board. Playground is a wiki where all users of Arduino can contribute and benefit from their collective research. Arduino official site has a section where you can find a list of Arduino based do-it-yourself project ideas. This list is helpful for both the novice and the experienced. Project ideas have been divided into three categories for easy navigation. The categories includes Easy, Intermediate and Advanced.

www.arduino.cc